

17 August 2026

GUIDELINE FOR INDUSTRY E-REPORTING

This document serves as a guideline to Applicants/ holders of certificates of registration (HCRs) on the method of submission of post-marketing Adverse Event (AE) reports for human medicines through the industry eReporting VigiFlow module. Thus, this guideline must be read in conjunction with the guideline on post-marketing reporting of adverse drug reactions (ADRs) to human medicines in South Africa for guidance on what to report to SAHPRA's Pharmacovigilance (PV) unit as well as the stipulated timelines. The Authority reserves the right to request any additional information to establish the safety, quality, and efficacy of a medicine and may make amendments to the approved conditions of registration in keeping with the knowledge that is current at the time of consideration of safety data.

Document History

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Contents

Document History.....	1
Glossary	4
1. INTRODUCTION	6
1.1 Purpose	6
1.2 Scope	7
2. LEGAL PROVISION.....	8
3. INDUSTRY eREPORTING	9
3.1 INITIAL CONSIDERATIONS	9
3.1.1 Technical and Operational Requirements.....	9
3.1.2 Transition from Previous Submission Methods	9
3.2 ACCOUNT SETUP	9
3.2.1 Application for user accounts	9
3.2.2 First-time login and password generation	12
3.3 MANAGE LICENCES.....	14
3.3.1 MedDRA	14
3.3.1.1 MedDRA License Validation Process.....	14
3.3.1.2 Using MedDRA in Data Entry	15
3.3.1.3 MedDRA Support	15
3.3.2 WHODrug	15
3.3.2.1 WHODrug License Validation Process.....	15
3.3.2.2 Using WHODrug in Data Entry	16
3.3.2.3 WHODrug Support	16
3.4 NAVIGATION.....	16
3.4.1 General System Information	16
3.4.2 How to create password for a new user account	17
3.4.3 Access to VigiFlow (Login)	18
3.4.4 Starting Screen	19
3.4.5 User Settings	20
3.4.6 Main Menu	20
3.4.6.1 Data Entry.....	20
3.4.6.2 E2B Upload.....	20
3.4.7 System Interface Overview	21

3.5	MANUAL DATA ENTRY.....	21
3.5.1	NullFlavor (NF) – Explanation and Usage.....	21
3.5.2	Icons and their actions	21
3.5.3	Create new report	22
3.5.3.1	Administrative.....	22
3.5.3.2	Patient	22
3.5.3.3	Drugs	22
3.5.3.4	Reactions.....	22
3.5.3.5	Drug-Reaction	22
3.5.3.6	Other	22
3.5.3.7	Assessments.....	23
3.5.3.8	Case summaries	23
3.5.3.9	Additional documents.....	23
3.5.3.10	Submit report.....	23
3.5.3.11	Download report.....	23
3.5.4	Edit report	24
3.6	NULLIFY REPORT	24
3.7	FOLLOW-UP REPORT	26
3.8	UPLOAD OF E2B XML FILES	27
4.	OTHER SYSTEM RELATED ISSUES.....	29
5.	REFERENCES	35
6.	VALIDITY	35
7.	APPENDICES	36
7.1	APPENDIX 1: Terms and Conditions	36
7.2	APPENDIX 2: ICH E2B ACKLOG	38
7.3	PPENDIX 2. ADDENDUM.....	40

Glossary

Abbreviation/ Term	Meaning
Acklog	Acknowledgment XML file
API key	Application Programming Interface key, is a unique code used to authenticate and securely access a software service, such as MedDRA.
AEFI	Adverse Event Following Immunisation
CIOMS	Council for International Organizations of Medicinal Sciences
CRO	Contract Research Organization
E2B	International standards for the electronic transmission of ICSR
ICH	International Council for Harmonisation
ICSR	Individual Case Safety Report
ISO	International Standards Organization
LLT	Lower-Level Term
LSO	Local Safety Officer
MedDRA	Medicinal Dictionary for Regulatory Activities
NRA	National Regulatory Authority
PBRER	Periodic Benefit Risk Evaluation Report
PI	Professional Information
PIDM	Programme for International Drug Monitoring.
PSMF	Pharmacovigilance Systems Master File
PSUR	Periodic Safety Update Reports
PV	Pharmacovigilance
QPPV	Qualified Person Responsible for Pharmacovigilance
R2, R3	Second revision, third revision
RMP	Risk Management Plan
SAHPRA	South African Health Products Regulatory Authority
SMQ	Standardized MedDRA Query
SOC	System Organ Class
SRUID	Safety Report Unique Identifier
UMC	Uppsala Monitoring Centre

WHO	World Health Organization
WHO Drug	WHO Drug Dictionary
WWUID	Worldwide unique case identification
XML	Extensible Markup Language, file format

APPROVED

1. INTRODUCTION

Industry eReporting is a web-based tool that allows Holders of Certificate of Registration (HCRs) or Applicants to submit Individual Case Safety Reports (ICSRs) and Adverse Events Following Immunisation (AEFIs) from an external interface directly to SAHPRA's National Database in the international standardised format. Industry eReporting further allows for both upload of the international standards for the electronic transmission of ICSR (E2B) XML files, in second revision (R2) or third revision (R3) format, or entering reports via manual data entry by HCRs.

Reporting of ICSR/AEFIs and monitoring thereof, is a viable means of identifying previously unrecognised, rare or serious ICSR/AEFIs. Every Applicant/ HCR is required to report to the Authority, ICSR/AEFIs known to them involving their marketed medicines in accordance with the requirements of Regulation 40 of the *Medicines and Related Substances Act, 101 of 1965*, as amended. The success of the Authority's ICSR/AEFIs reporting system depends on the quality, completeness, and accuracy of the information submitted. The Authority makes decisions and takes regulatory actions such as updating a Professional Information and Patient Information Leaflet, restricting the use of a product in certain populations and withdrawal of a product from the South African market, therefore contributing to international data regarding risks and effectiveness of medicines, and imparting health product safety knowledge that benefits all South Africans.

1.1 Purpose

This document is intended to guide to HCRs or Applicants on how to register and report "reportable" post-marketing adverse event reports for human medicines using Industry eReporting VigiFlow module, in accordance with SAHPRA requirements specified in the Guideline on Post-marketing reporting of ADRs to human medicines in South Africa (SAHPGL-CEM-PV-04).

In collaboration with Uppsala Monitoring Centre (UMC), SAHPRA has launched an Industry e-Reporting tool, already piloted by some countries such as Mexico and Pakistan, to name a few. As of 01 September 2026, HCRs/ Applicants are required to submit post-marketing adverse event reports for human medicines through a manual data entry module or E2B upload module using the new tool of industry e-Reporting.

The eReporting for Industry, developed and maintained by the UMC, enables HCRs or Applicants to submit reports directly to the National Database, either by manually entering data or uploading E2B XML files:

- The manual entry module is an electronic form based on the ICH-E2B (R3) standard, allowing structured and standardized data entry. **This replaces previous hard copy CIOMS form (S01) submissions.**

- HCRs or Applicants who previously submitted XML reports via email can transition to the E2B module, which supports both R2 and R3 formats. **This replaces E2B report submissions via email.**

Key features of eReporting for Industry include:

- Compatibility with the ICH-E2B standard
- Preference for structured fields over free-text fields
- Use of standardized MedDRA and WHODrug terminology
- Ability to attach relevant additional information in PDF format
- Immediate transmission of reports to SAHPRA
- Submission of follow-up reports by uploading and editing the original and previous XML files (available only for manual data entry; see Section 8 for instructions)
- Capability to download an electronic acknowledgment receipt (acklog) in XML format

NOTE:

- Using the MedDRA and WHODrug Global dictionaries for medical coding in reporting adverse events makes it much easier to record and analyze patient data in a consistent and accessible way. Therefore, SAHPRA advises HCRs to use both MedDRA and WHODrug while reporting to ensure proper terminologies are used in reporting, as our database terminologies are coded based on these dictionaries. ***In the future, SAHPRA will make the use of MedDRA and WHO-Drug mandatory for reporting adverse events by all HCRs.***

1.2 Scope

This guide covers all reportable post-marketing adverse event reports for human medicines received by HCRs or Applicants from various sources, including consumers, healthcare professionals, literature, and other media sources, as per the Guideline on Post-marketing reporting of ADRs to human medicines in South Africa (SAHPGL-CEM-PV-04).

Submission of all post-marketing adverse event reports for human medicines includes:

- Initial reports

- Follow-up reports
- Nullification of reports
- Duplicate reports handling

Reporting of ADRs/ AEFIs and Serious Adverse Events (SAEs) related to unregistered medicines, obtained via section 21 of the Medicines and Related Substances Control Act, active pharmaceutical ingredients used in compounded medicines (Category B), registered and marketed veterinary medicines (Category C), incident reports for medical devices, and in vitro diagnostics (IVDs) through the Industry eReporting VigiFlow Portal is not permitted.

2. LEGAL PROVISION

This document is intended for HCRs or Applicants. In accordance with Regulation 40 issued in terms of the Medicines and Related Substances Act, 101 of 1965, as amended.

- (1) A person who has applied for the registration of a medicine in terms of section 15 of the Act, a holder of a certificate of registration in respect of a medicine or scheduled substance, or a holder of a licence in terms of section 22C (1) (b) must inform the Authority, in the manner and within the timeframe as determined by the Authority. A holder of certificate of registration (HCR)/Applicant and Licence Holder must inform the Authority of any:
 - (a) new or existing quality, safety or effectiveness concerns related to any medicine or scheduled substance, including but not limited to adverse drug reactions; and
 - (b) risk management activities associated with paragraph (1).
- (2) A person who has applied for registration of a medicine in terms of Section 15 of the Act, a holder of a certificate of registration in respect of a medicine or scheduled substance, or a holder of a licence in terms of section 22C (1) (b) must maintain or have access to records of the reports and case reports referred to in sub regulation (1) above.

3. INDUSTRY eREPORTING

3.1 INITIAL CONSIDERATIONS

3.1.1 Technical and Operational Requirements

- Ensure that the equipment used to load case data is connected to a stable power source or backup system, and that a reliable high-speed internet connection is maintained. Unstable internet or power interruptions can result in the loss data if a report has not yet been submitted.
- Use Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, or Microsoft Edge (in that order of preference). Always keep your browser updated for best results.
- Do not share access credentials. Protect the confidentiality and integrity of user accounts and passwords.
- Log out of eReporting for Industry when it is not actively being used to enter information.
- Adhere to the provisions outlined in the *Terms and Conditions* document (Appendix 1).

3.1.2 Transition from Previous Submission Methods

If your organisation previously submitted reports via email or in hard copy format, follow these instructions carefully:

- 3.1.2.1 Only new individual case safety reports (ICSRs) and their follow-ups should be submitted through eReporting for Industry.
- 3.1.2.2 Reports submitted through previous channels must continue to be managed through the same method. For example, if the initial and follow-up reports were sent via email, the case must also be closed via email, even if you are now using eReporting for Industry.
- 3.1.2.3 As of 01 September 2026, HCRs/ Applicants are required to submit all new post-marketing adverse event reports for human medicines and their follow-ups through a manual data entry module or E2B upload module using the new tool of Industry e-Reporting.

3.2 ACCOUNT SETUP

3.2.1 Application for user accounts

- SAHPRA will be responsible for granting access to eReporting for Applicants.

- Applicants are required to register for the Industry eReporting VigiFlow module by completing the relevant table on the addendum in Appendix 3 below.
- Send the completed addendum to industryereporting@sahpra.org.za.
- The submitted addendum will be processed, and confirmation of system configuration will be communicated to the HCR/ Applicant within five (5) working days.
- Once confirmation is received, HCRs/ Applicants can start submitting reports via Industry eReporting module
- To request any account modifications (deactivation/ replacement, including during leave of absence), please send an email to the address provided above, including the new details as specified in the addendum.
- SAHPRA will grant access to a maximum of three user accounts.
- The email address provided for each user account must be a corporate or institutional email.
- Access to the system is granted based on the individual's email address, which implies that access through the company PV mailbox will only be granted to one person, and the remaining two individuals will be granted access using their institutional email addresses.
- It is the Applicant's responsibility to request User deactivation due to resignation or other operational reasons within 5 working days of the effectiveness of such.

Information required in the application:

Field	Description
Long name <i>(Maximum 254 characters)</i>	It is proposed that this be the company's legal name. The long name will appear in the upper left quadrant of the interface, allowing the user to confirm that it has accessed the correct session <i>Example:</i> MedSolutions Laboratories
Short name <i>(Maximum 20 characters)</i>	It will be part of the Worldwide Unique Case Identification (WWUID) and will also appear in the Safety Report Unique Identifier (SRUID). <i>Example:</i> MedSolutions > WWUID and SRUID: [ZA]-MedSolutions-00001

	For companies with E2B databases, the relevant fields are: • E2B (R2): <companynumb> • E2B (R3): 2.16.840.1.113883.3.989.2.1.3.2 (refer to ICH guide, point C.1.8.1: <i>Worldwide Unique Case Identification Number</i>) Companies without E2B databases may propose a short name and define it together with SAHPRA. Once the short name is defined, it cannot be modified later in the production phase.
Sender Identifier (Maximum 60 characters)	This corresponds to the issuer identifier and is the code that enables electronic transmission between databases. For companies with E2B databases, the relevant fields are: • E2B (R2): <messagesenderidentifier> (refer to ICH guide, point M.1.5: Message Sender Identifier) • E2B (R3): 2.16.840.1.113883.3.989.2.1.3.11 (refer to ICH guide, point N.2.r.2: <i>Message Sender Identifier</i>) The sender identifier may sometimes be the same as the short name, but this is not always the case. Companies without E2B databases may propose a sender identifier and define it together with SAHPRA. Once the sender identifier is defined, it cannot be modified later in the production phase.
Sender organization (Maximum 100 characters)	For companies with E2B databases, the relevant fields are: • E2B (R2): <sender organization> (refer to ICH guide, point A.3.1.2: Sender organization). • E2B (R3): refer to ICH guide, point C.3.2: Sender's Organization. The sender organization may sometimes be the same as the short name and/or the sender identifier, but this is not always the case. Companies without E2B databases may propose a sender organization and define it together with SAHPRA. Once the sender organization is defined, it cannot be modified later in the production phase.
Users (Maximum 3 users)	• Full name (first name(s) and surname(s)) • Corporate or institutional email address

ICH E2B references:

- ICH E2B(R2): <https://www.ich.org/page/e2br2-icsr-specification-and-related-files>

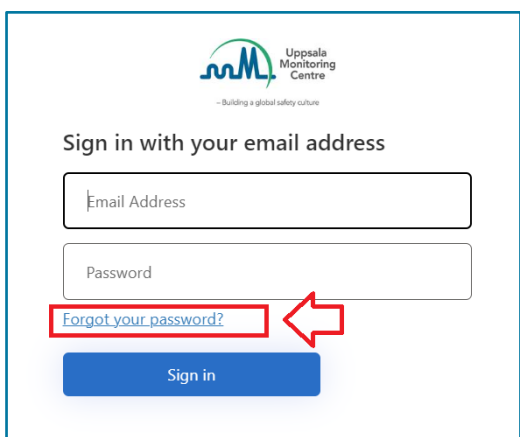
- ICH E2B(R3): <https://www.ich.org/page/e2br3-individual-case-safety-report-icsr-specification-and-related-files>

3.2.2 First-time login and password generation

Once SAHPRA has granted you access to Industry e-Reporting, you must follow the following steps to generate your password:

3.2.2.1 To log in and generate your password, you must go to the following link (it is recommended not to save the link in the favourites section of your browser and access from the one found in this Guide or on the SAHPRA website): <https://industryreporting.who-umc.org/>.

3.2.2.2 Click on the **Forgot your password?** link and follow the instructions to create a new password.

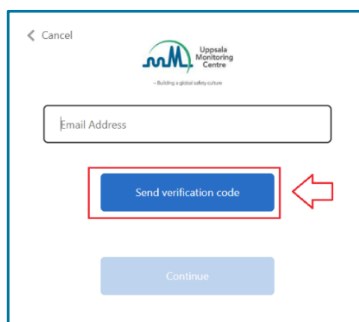


IMPORTANT

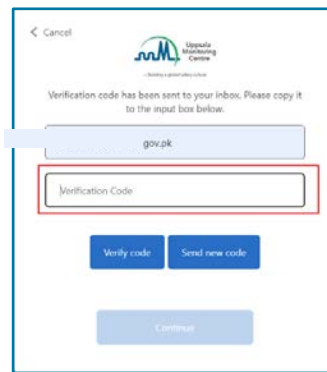
Do not enable automatic translation in your web browser. This may result in inaccurate translations of certain fields, which could lead to data entry errors or misinterpretation of critical information. To change the interface language, follow the instructions on point 7.4 *User settings*.

3.2.2.3 In the **Email Address** field, you will need to enter your username (email).

3.2.2.4 Press the **Send verification code** button and **do not close** the Industry e-Reporting window.

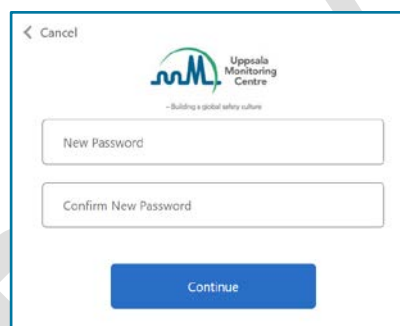


3.2.2.5 A 6-digit code will be sent to your email. Upon receipt, enter the **Verification Code** field and press the **Verify code** button.



3.2.2.6 If the code is correct, it will show you the message “The code has been verified. You can now continue”.

3.2.2.7 Press the **Continue** button.



3.2.2.8 A screen will be displayed where you will need to enter your new password. It must not resemble your username.

3.2.2.9 Type the same password in the box below to confirm it and press the Continue button.

3.2.2.10 If the process is successful, the system will redirect you to the home screen to enter your username and password.

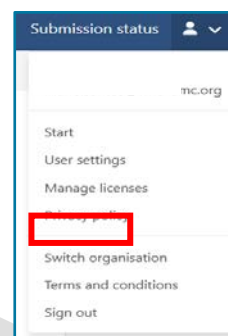
If you do not remember your password, the recovery must be carried out with the same procedure described above.

3.3 MANAGE LICENCES

To manage your MedDRA and/or WHODrug licenses, locate the **Manage licenses** option in the upper right menu.

Once the licenses are activated, you do not need to repeat the activation process each time you log in.

If a license expires, eReporting for Industry will block data entry in the MedDRA and WHODrug fields. To resolve this, go to the upper right menu and check the license status. For support, please contact the appropriate organisation: MSSO for MedDRA and UMC for WHODrug.



3.3.1 MedDRA

To use MedDRA within eReporting for Industry, you must activate your license within the Industry eReporting system. Note that this requires obtaining and registering an **API key** to validate your company's MedDRA license.

3.3.1.1 MedDRA License Validation Process

- (a) Go to the following external site: <https://mid.meddra.org/account/register>.
- (b) Enter your MedDRA *Username* and *Password*, then click **Login**.
- (c) If the login is successful, the page will display your **API key**.
- (d) If unsuccessful, verify your credentials and try again, or contact MSSO.
- (e) Copy the **API key** and log in to eReporting for Industry.
- (f) In the upper right menu, click on **Manage Licenses**. Enter your **MedDRA ID** in the first field and the **API key** in the second field.

A screenshot of the 'Manage MedDRA license' form. The form has a title 'Manage MedDRA license' and two input fields: 'MedDRA ID' and 'MedDRA API key'. A red rectangular box highlights these two input fields. Below the input fields, there is a link 'Register for a new MedDRA API key' and a 'Save' button. Below this section, there is another section titled 'Manage WHODrug license' with a 'WHODrug license number' input field and a 'Save' button.

- (g) Click **Save** and if the process is successful, a confirmation message will appear indicating that your license has been validated for use within Industry eReporting VigiFlow module.

3.3.1.2 Using MedDRA in Data Entry

When entering or editing a report, you will be able to search for MedDRA terms in the relevant fields. These fields are marked with the label (*MedDRA*) to indicate that MedDRA coding is supported.

The MedDRA viewer integrated into Industry eReporting allows for general term searches. However, it is not intended to replace the full functionality of the MedDRA web browser. For extended searches or detailed browsing, use the official MedDRA browser: <https://wbb.meddra.org/autologin>

3.3.1.3 MedDRA Support

For support regarding MedDRA licensing or subscription models, contact MSSO directly:

- Web form available at <https://www.meddra.org/subscription/process>
- Email: mssohelp@meddra.org

DISCLAIMER: SAHPRA does not receive any benefit from the acquisition of MedDRA licenses and is not involved in the licensing process.

3.3.2 WHODrug

Systematic coding of medicines ensures traceability throughout the process of adverse reaction reporting, data analysis, and risk communication related to medicines and vaccines. UMC's Drug Dictionary (UMCDD), WHODrug Global, is a globally recognized terminology developed and maintained by the Uppsala Monitoring Centre (UMC).

To use WHODrug within eReporting for Industry, you must activate your license within the Industry eReporting system.

3.3.2.1 WHODrug License Validation Process

- (a) In the upper right menu, select Manage Licenses.
- (b) Enter your **WHODrug license number** in the designated field and click **Save**.



The image shows two web forms. The top form is titled 'Manage MedDRA license' and contains fields for 'MedDRA ID' and 'MedDRA API key', with a 'Register for a new MedDRA API key' link and a 'Submit' button. The bottom form is titled 'Manage WHODrug license' and contains a 'WHODrug license number' field with a 'Submit' button. This bottom form is highlighted with a red rectangular border.

- (c) If successful, a confirmation message will appear indicating that your license has been validated for use within eReporting for Industry.

3.3.2.2 Using WHODrug in Data Entry

When entering or editing a report, you will be able to search for WHODrug terms in the relevant fields. These fields are marked with the label (WHODrug) to indicate that WHODrug coding is supported. The WHODrug viewer in Industry eReporting supports general term searches and for extended or detailed browsing, use the official WHODrug browser, WHODrug Insight: <https://insight.who-umc.org/> (available only to licensed users).

UMC suggests coding as specifically as possible using the C3 format, based on the available information. For detailed guidance, consult the following documents (available only to licensed users in the WHODrug User Area: <https://who-umc.org/whodrug-user-area/>):

- *How to Use WHODrug C3 Format for Drug Coding*
- *Technical Guide for the Use of WHODrug Global in XML Files Uploaded in VigiFlow eReporting for Industry for E2B(R3) Compliance*

3.3.2.3 WHODrug Support

For assistance with WHODrug licensing or subscription options, please contact UMC directly using the web form available at: <https://who-umc.org/whodrug/whodrug-subscription/product-enquiry/>.

DISCLAIMER: SAHPRA does not receive any benefit from the acquisition of WHODrug licenses and is not involved in the licensing process.

3.4 NAVIGATION

3.4.1 General System Information

- **URL:** <https://industryreporting.who-umc.org>

- **Username:** Your e-mail address
- **Password:** Set your own password by clicking the link “Forgot your password?” on the login page and following the instructions.
- If you experience login issues, please contact SAHPRA Pharmacovigilance Unit at industryreporting@sahpra.org.za.
- Submission information, including acklogs, stays in the ‘Submission status’ section for thirty-five (35) days.
- It is important to check the acklog for each submission to verify all reports are accepted by the regulatory authority’s database. Submission status “Completed” does not automatically mean that all reports are successfully received by the regulatory authority.

3.4.2 How to create password for a new user account

Follow the steps below, to create your password and login to Industry eReporting for the first time:

- (a) Go to <https://industryreporting.who-umc.org> and click the link “Forgot your password?”
- (b) Enter your e-mail address and click “Send verification code”. Keep this window open and check your mailbox. You should receive an e-mail from msonlineserviceteam@microsoftonline.com with a 6-digit code. *(If you don’t receive an e-mail, check your spam folder.)*
- (c) Enter the 6-digit code in the box “verification code”, click “Verify code”
- (d) Click “Continue”
- (e) Choose your password, click “Continue”
- (f) You have now set your password and can login from the login page.

1 Sign in with your email address

Email Address

Password

Forgot your password?

Sign in

2 your.self@vigimail.com

Send verification code

Continue

3 Verification code has been sent. Please copy it to the input box below.

your.self@vigimail.com

123456

Enter the 6-digit code received to your e-mail inbox

Verify code

Send new code

Continue

4 The code has been verified. You can now continue.

your.self@vigimail.com

Change

Continue

5 New Password

Confirm New Password

Choose your password and type it again to confirm

Continue

3.4.3 Access to VigiFlow (Login)

- Go to the following link: <https://industryreporting.who-umc.org/>
- Enter your username and password in the corresponding fields.

(c) Press the **Sign in** button.



3.4.4 Starting Screen

Once you have logged in, you will find the main screen:



In the upper right corner of the screen, you will find the main menu, which provides access to the system's available functions. Each function is described in detail in the table below:

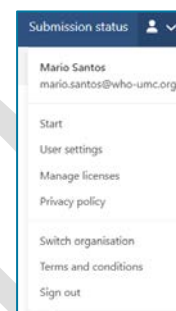
Function	Description
Start	Moves you to the main screen.
User Settings	Allows you to change the interface language.
Manage Licenses	MedDRA & WHODrug license administration.
Privacy Policy	Redirects you to the UMC website where the privacy policy is described.
Terms and Conditions	Displays the legal clauses that define how the system may be used.

Sign out	Logs you out of the system. Important: If you are entering a report, make sure you have submitted and downloaded it first before navigating to the home screen. Otherwise, the information entered will be lost.
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3.4.5 User Settings

To change the interface language, locate the **User settings** option in the upper right menu.

Select **English** as your native language to automatically populate fields where a language selection is required for a specific term. To save the changes, click **Save**. Then return to the main screen by selecting **Start** from the upper right menu.



3.4.6 Main Menu

There are two methods available for entering a new report into the system:

- (1) **Data Entry:** This option is used for manually entering report information directly into the system.
 - I. Create new report: for creating a new Individual Case Safety Report (ICSR) and managing it within the system.
 - II. Edit report: Allows you to load and modify a previously entered ICSR not yet submitted to SAHPRA.
 - III. Follow up report: Enables you to upload a previously entered ICSR for follow-up purposes.
 - IV. Nullify report: Allows you to withdraw an ICSR that was previously created using this system.
- (2) **E2B Upload:** This module is used for uploading reports in XML format, following the E2B standard.

3.4.6.1 Data Entry

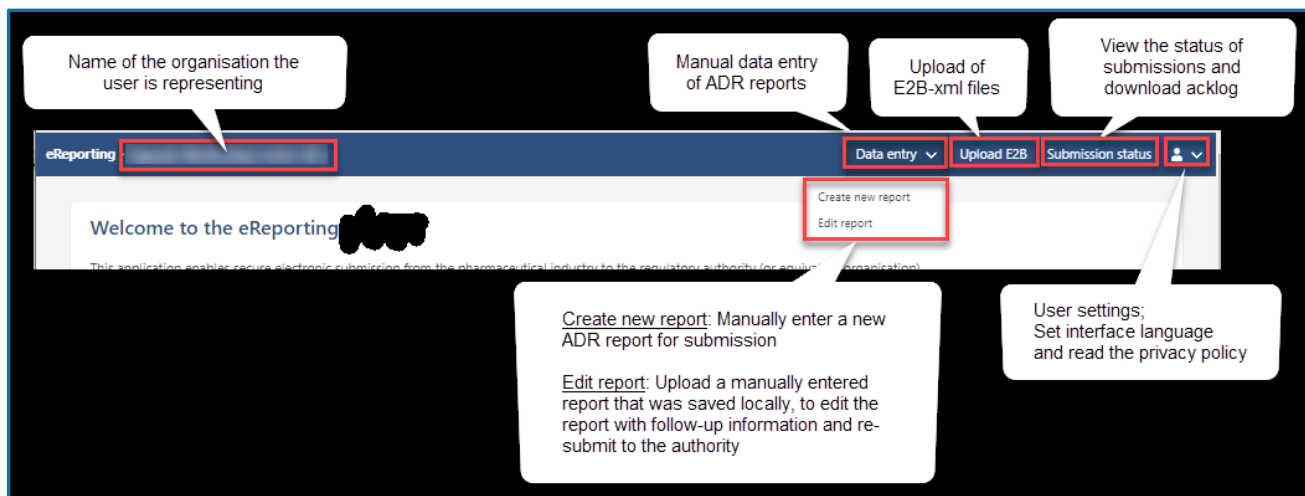
To understand how to use the Data Entry module and SAHPRA's expectations regarding its proper use, please consult **Section 3.5 – Manual Data Entry**.

3.4.6.2 E2B Upload

To understand how to use the E2B Upload module and SAHPRA's expectations regarding its proper use, please consult **Section 3.8 - E2B Upload**.

3.4.7 System Interface Overview

Quick overview of the start page of Industry eReporting



3.5 MANUAL DATA ENTRY

3.5.1 NullFlavor (NF) – Explanation and Usage

NullFlavor (NF) codes are used to indicate why a valid value is not provided in certain fields. These codes are only justified when the system requires a value in a mandatory field in order to submit the report to SAHPRA. Mandatory fields necessary for submission are highlighted in red by the system.

If a field contains an NF code and the information is unavailable — but the field is not required for submission — you may leave it blank. In such cases, the system will retain the default NF marker automatically. Common NF codes include:

- Unknown – The information is not known.
- Asked but unknown – The information was requested but not provided.
- Not asked – The information was not requested.
- Masked/concealed – The information is intentionally hidden.

3.5.2 Icons and their actions

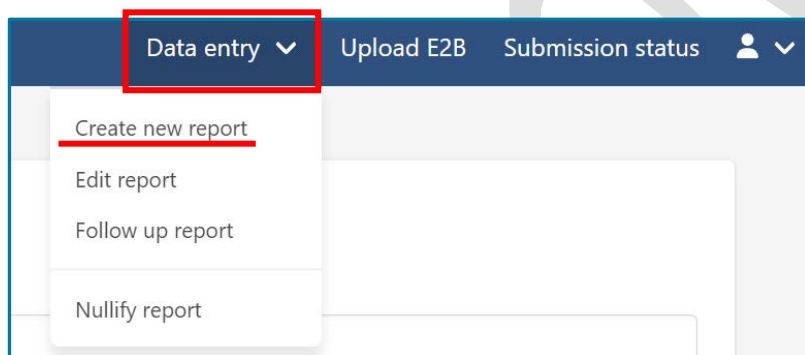
	This button allows you to add a corresponding section or field at its location. Examples include <i>Medication</i>, <i>Therapeutic Indication</i>, <i>Dose</i>, <i>Reactions</i>, <i>Causality Evaluation</i>, etc.
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	This button allows you to delete a specific field or an entire section where it is located. IMPORTANT: If you delete a section or field that is essential for submitting the report, you will need to re-enter the required information before submission.
	This button lets you proceed to the next section. In the manual data entry module, it is not mandatory to complete a section before moving on. However, at the end of the process, the system will highlight in red any mandatory fields that are incomplete. You will need to return to those sections to provide or correct the missing information before submission.

3.5.3 Create new report

This module provides step-by-step instructions on how to create a new Individual Case Safety Report (ICSR) and manage it within Industry eReporting VigiFlow module.

To begin manual data entry, locate the **Data Entry** option in the upper-right menu of the interface and select **Create new report**:



For guidance on what should be entered in each specific data entry field, refer to the ICH guidelines: <https://ich.org/page/e2br3-individual-case-safety-report-icsr-specification-and-related-files>.

The report creation process is divided into eight (8) sections, as outlined below:

3.5.3.1 Administrative

3.5.3.2 Patient

3.5.3.3 Drugs

3.5.3.4 Reactions

3.5.3.5 Drug-Reaction

3.5.3.6 Other

3.5.3.7 Assessments

3.5.3.8 Case summaries

3.5.3.9 Additional documents

This section will allow you to upload documents relevant to the causality assessment of the case. Some examples can be (but are not limited to these):

- Test results
- Death certificate
- Vaccination certificate

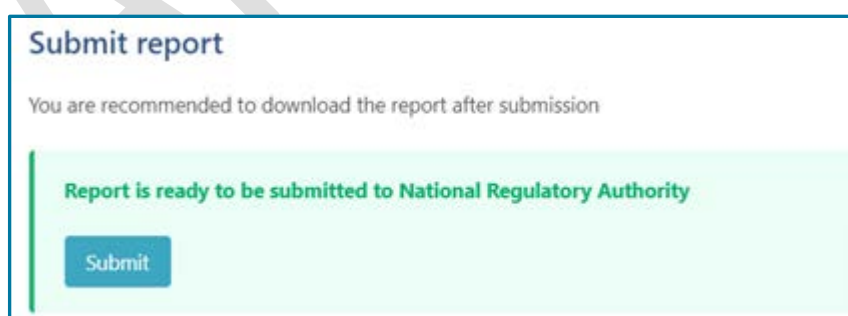
Place the name of the document in the free text field and upload the file in PDF format, either by dragging and dropping it into the grey section or by opening it from your file explorer with the "Browse" option.

If you need to attach more documents, you can do so with the "Add additional document" option.

Important: Documents must be in PDF format and must not exceed 2 MB in size to ensure they can be uploaded without issues.

3.5.3.10 Submit report

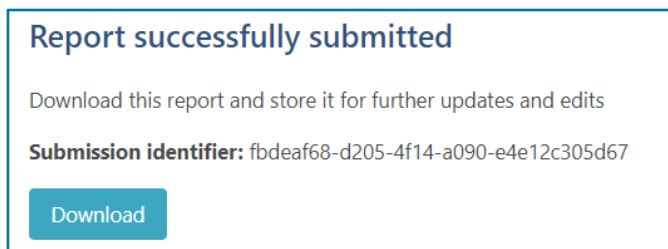
Before submitting the report, ensure that all required information has been entered - The report must meet at least the four fundamental criteria (Information Quality Grade 0). If any mandatory data is missing or incorrect, this section will **highlight the issues in red**, indicating what needs to be added or corrected. Once all required information is complete, click **Submit** to proceed.



3.5.3.11 Download report

After submitting the report, it is essential to download the XML file immediately. This file is the only way to track the case and contains all the data captured during the report process.

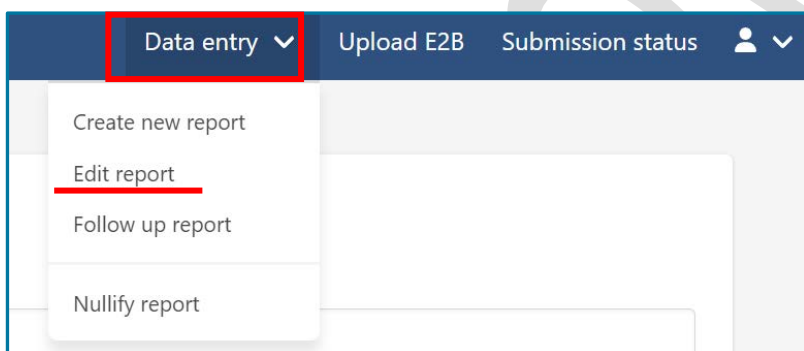
Click **Download** to save the XML file. The system will automatically name the file using the Worldwide Unique Case Identifier (WWUID). Be sure to store this file in a secure backup location, as it will be needed for any future follow-up on the case.



3.5.4 Edit report

This option allows you to upload and edit an ICSR (E2B XML file) that was created in the system but has not yet been submitted to the regulatory authority.

- (1) From the top menu, select **Edit report**.

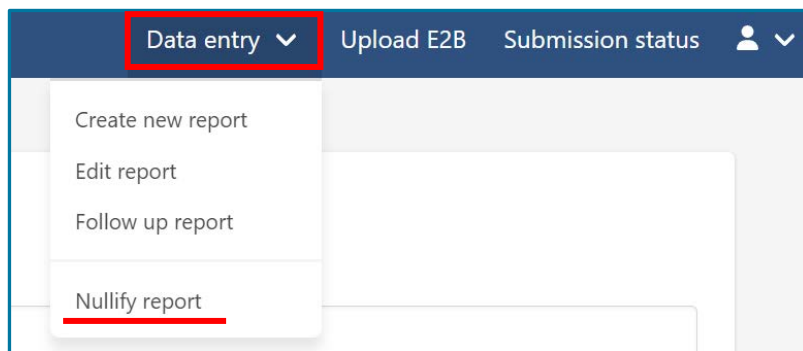


- (2) Upload the XML file generated during the initial submission. You can do this by either dragging and dropping the file into the grey upload area, or by clicking **Browse** to locate and select the file from your computer.

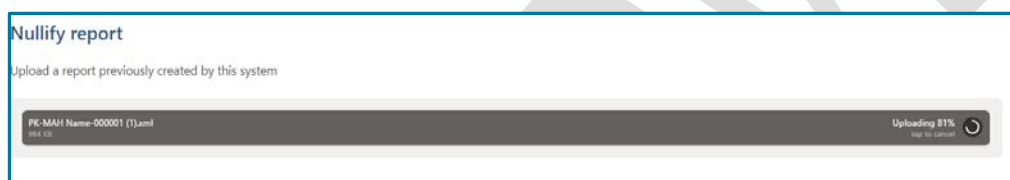
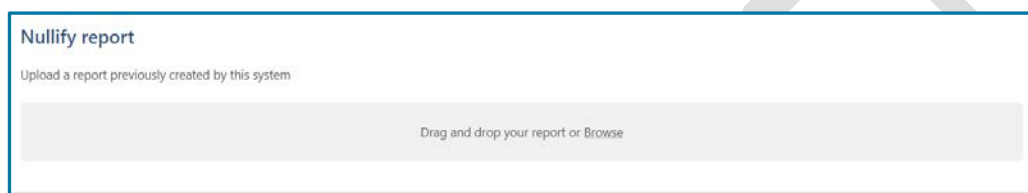
3.6 NULLIFY REPORT

This option allows you to permanently delete a previously transmitted case—for example, if the entire ICSR was incorrect or if it was submitted as a duplicate.

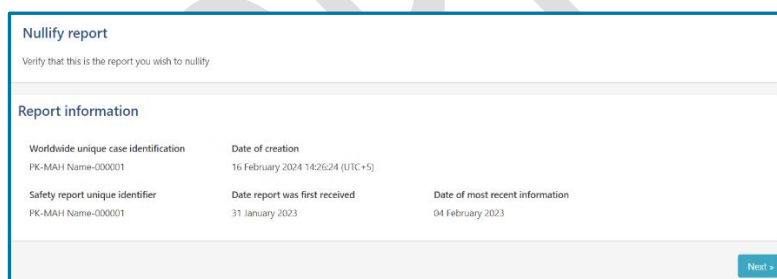
From the top menu, select Nullify report.



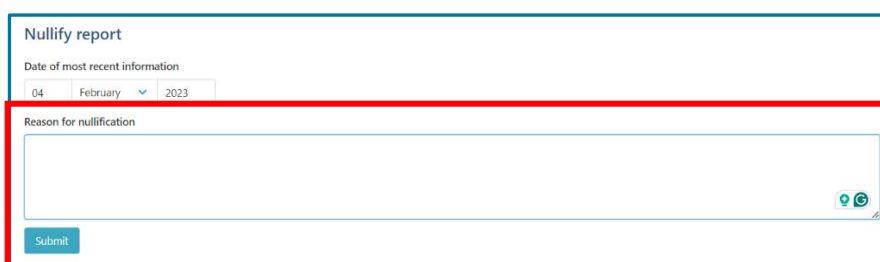
Upload the XML file generated during the initial submission. You can do this by either dragging and dropping the file into the grey upload area, or by clicking Browse to locate and select the file from your computer.



Review the report details to confirm that this is the correct case to be nullified and if everything is correct, click **Next**.



Enter the reason for nullification in the designated field and click **Submit** to complete the nullification process.

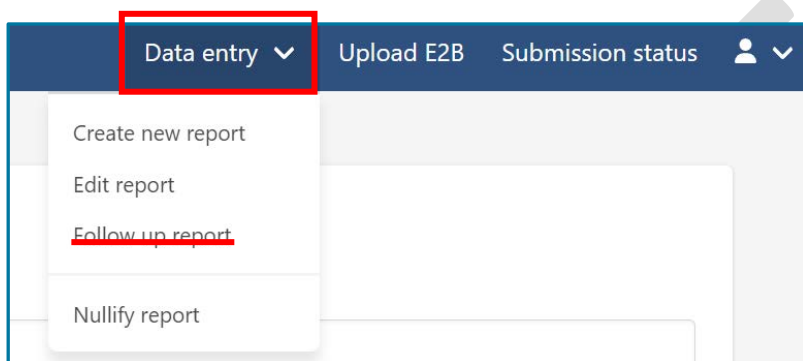


Download the nullified report's XML file and save it to your computer since this file will be required for any future updates or references related to the case.

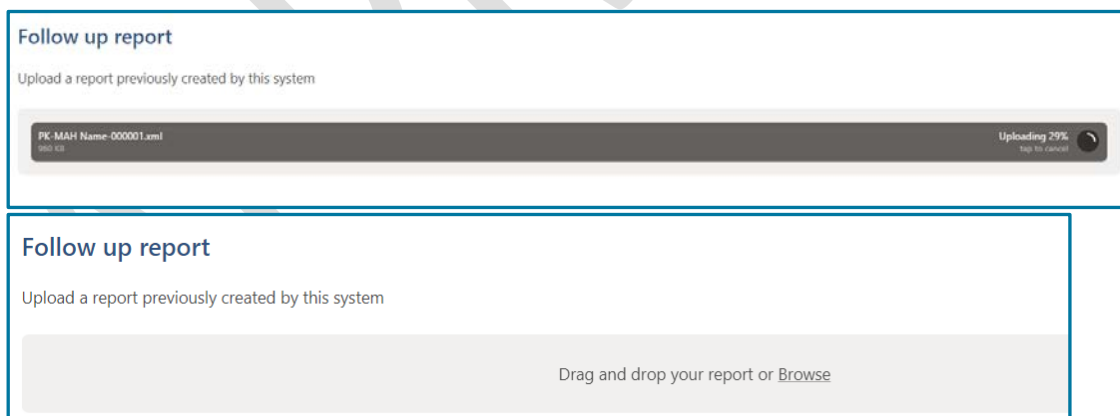
3.7 FOLLOW-UP REPORT

This option allows you to upload an existing an ICSR (E2B XML file) created in this system to add follow-up information—that is, new or updated data obtained after the initial case report has already been submitted to the regulatory authority.

- i) From the top menu, select **Follow up report**.



- ii) Upload the XML file generated during the initial submission. You can do this by either dragging and dropping the file into the grey upload area, or by clicking **Browse** to locate and select the file from your computer.



- iii) Once the file is uploaded, the report will load automatically, and all sections will be available for editing.
- iv) Enter the new or updated information in the appropriate fields and be sure to update the “Date of most recent information” to reflect the date you received the follow-up data.
- v) In the “Case narrative”, clearly separate the new information from previous entries. Use a

horizontal line and label the new section as Follow-up 1, Follow-up 2, etc., as appropriate.

IMPORTANT: Do not use the acknowledgment file (*acklog*) available in the *Submission Status* tab for follow-up submissions since it is not intended for this purpose.

3.8 UPLOAD OF E2B XML FILES

This module is intended exclusively for HCRs or Applicants who already have a database capable of transmitting E2B XML files in accordance with ICH guidelines.

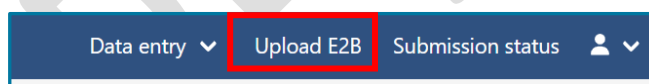
Industry eReporting is based on the ICH E2B standard, which defines the required data elements and field structure for ICSRs. Data elements in addition to this standard are not considered.

Scientific publications for case reports published in literature may be embedded in an E2B(R3) message in the user's system, as described in the E2B(R3) Electronic Transmission of Individual Case Safety Reports Implementation Guide.

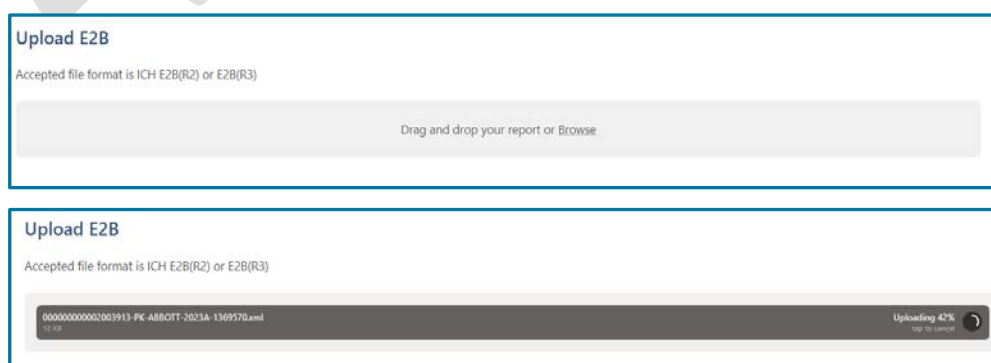
Note that batch uploads are supported, and you can upload up to 100 ICSRs per XML file. A single acknowledgment log (*acklog*) will be generated for the entire batch.

In the section “*Upload E2B*”, reports in E2B-XML format may be uploaded and submitted to the regulatory authority:

- i) Go to 'Upload E2B' in the top menu



- ii) Browse Upload files one at a time. Either drag and drop the XML file into the grey box or click **Browse** to select it from your file explorer.

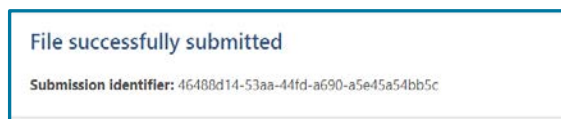


- iii) Once selected, the file will begin uploading automatically. If the file complies with ICH R2 or R3

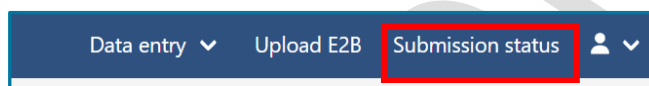
format specifications, it will upload successfully. A confirmation message will appear.



- iv) Click **Submit** to send the report. Note the *Submission Identifier* displayed after sending since you'll need it for tracking.



- v) Go to **Submission status** in the top menu



- vi) Check that the status is "Completed" and download the acklog to verify all reports in the file were correctly received by the regulatory authority. Locate your report using the *Submission Identifier* and click the download icon  to retrieve the *acklog* file

Submissions are available for 35 days after completion				
Submission time	Submission identifier	Completion time	Status	Download
> 16 February 2024 14:29:33 (UTC+5)	46488d14-53aa-44fd-a690-a5e45a54bb5c	16 February 2024 14:29:43 (UTC+5)	All rejected	
> 16 February 2024 14:28:07 (UTC+5)	88295760-bf01-4af4-aa90-0ce66fe26e29	16 February 2024 14:28:17 (UTC+5)	Accepted	
> 16 February 2024 14:26:25 (UTC+5)	0b83fd9f-e342-469f-8430-f4773c048273	16 February 2024 14:26:37 (UTC+5)	Accepted	
> 15 February 2024 14:15:47 (UTC+5)	fbdeaf68-d205-4f14-a090-e4e12c305d67	15 February 2024 14:16:14 (UTC+5)	Accepted	

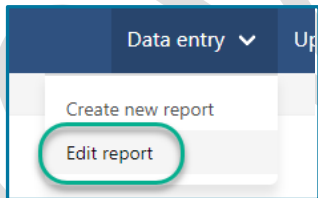
- vii) Upload the acklog to your internal system to confirm successful import.
- viii) Check that the status is "Completed" and download the acklog to verify all reports in the file were correctly received by the regulatory authority.
- ix) If any reports are rejected according to the acklog and you require assistance, please contact SAHPRA's Pharmacovigilance Unit at industryreporting@sahpra.org.za.

NOTE: It is essential to download the *acklog* file immediately after uploading the XML, as the system only

retains submission history for **35 days**. After this period, the *acklog* will no longer be available for download.

It is the HCRs or Applicant responsibility to back up all generated acklogs.

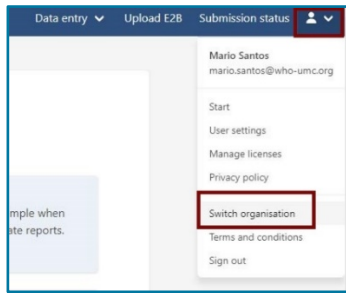
4. OTHER SYSTEM RELATED ISSUES

Manual data entry	
Q1. Is there specific guidance for what should be entered in each specific data entry field?	ICH guidelines: https://ich.org/page/e2br3-individual-case-safety-report-icsr-specification-and-related-files
Q2. How do I submit a follow up report?	Go to Data Entry → Edit report, browse for the initial report (saved locally) and upload it. Add the follow-up information and submit the report. Note: This can only be done for reports that were initially created in Industry eReporting. 
Q3. Is there a size limitation for attachments?	Yes, max 15 MB per report in total.
Q4. After clicking “Submit”, will I be notified that the report has been sent?	No. You need to verify that the report is sent and accepted by: Ensuring that the submission status is “Completed” and Checking the acklog to verify the report was accepted (see also <i>Appendix 2</i> below).
Q5. How can I nullify a report that was sent via manual data entry?	Please contact SAHPRA’s Pharmacovigilance Unit at adr@sahpra.org.za .
E2B upload	
Q6. What happens if I submit the same XML file twice by accident?	The file is re-sent to the regulatory authority. The system will not indicate that the same file had already been sent.
Q7. After clicking “Submit”, will I be notified that the file has been sent?	No. You need to verify that the file is sent and accepted by: a) Ensuring that the submission status is “Completed”

	<u>and</u> b) Checking the acklog to verify the reports in the file were accepted. See also question Q10.
Q8. Does status “Completed” mean all reports in a file are successfully received by the regulatory authority?	No. “<i>Completed</i>” means the file has been successfully sent from the Industry eReporting tool. To make sure all reports are successfully received by the regulatory authority’s database, the acklog needs to be checked (see also <i>Appendix 2</i> below).
Q9. My database does not upload acklogs – how can I read and understand the acklog manually?	Acklog codes are described in <i>Appendix 2</i> to this document.
Q10. What does status “pending” mean?	“ <i>Pending</i> ” means the file has not yet been successfully sent from eReporting, for example if the regulatory authority’s database is temporarily down. eReporting will automatically try to re-send the file within 72 hours.
Q11. How long will the submission status and acklogs be visible in the ‘Submission status’ tab?	Thirty-five (35) days after submission, the information and corresponding acklogs will no longer be available in Industry eReporting.
GENERAL FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS	
Q12. Can I use eReporting for Industry as my own database?	No , eReporting for Industry is a one-way submission system and does not function as a database for HCR.
Q13. Can I submit PDF or Excel files through eReporting for Industry?	No , submissions must be made either through manual data entry or via E2B Upload (XML format).
Q14. How should follow-ups for reports submitted before this module was implemented be handled?	Continue submitting follow-ups via the original method to adr@sahpra.org.za or e2b@sahpra.org.za until the case is closed.
Q15. Can I report a case that occurred outside of the country?	No , the system is intended for reporting cases that occur within South Africa. Submission of foreign-sourced ICSRs to SAHPRA is outlined in the guideline: Post-marketing Reporting of Adverse Drug Reactions for Human Medicines in South Africa
Q16. What are the minimum criteria for submitting a report?	A valid report must include: • An identifiable reporter • An identifiable patient

	- At least one suspected drug - At least one adverse reaction																									
Q17. Can I save a case and complete it later?	No, the system does not support saving drafts. You must complete, submit, or download the report in a single session. Downloading the report is only possible if it meets the minimum submission criteria outlined in the previous question. Note that any unsaved data will be lost upon logout.																									
Q18. Is there a time limit for entering a case?	There is no fixed time limit, but inactivity will result in automatic logout for security reasons. Keep interacting with the system to maintain your session.																									
Q19. What if I forgot to download the report after submission?	You can still download it from the Submission Status tab within 35 days - however, it's recommended to download and save it immediately after submission. Locate your report using the Submission Identifier and click the download icon to retrieve the XML file. Submission status Submissions are available for 35 days after completion <table><thead><tr><th>Submission time</th><th>Submission identifier</th><th>Completion time</th><th>Status</th><th>Download</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>16 February 2024 14:29:33 (UTC+5)</td><td>46488d14-53aa-4f8d-a660-a5e45a540b3c</td><td>16 February 2024 14:29:43 (UTC+5)</td><td>All rejected</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>16 February 2024 14:28:07 (UTC+5)</td><td>682b750-b071-4a74-a090-0ce6bfc2a629</td><td>16 February 2024 14:28:17 (UTC+5)</td><td>Accepted</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>16 February 2024 14:26:25 (UTC+5)</td><td>0b83d99f-e342-469f-8430-14773c348273</td><td>16 February 2024 14:26:37 (UTC+5)</td><td>Accepted</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>15 February 2024 14:15:47 (UTC+5)</td><td>f0deaf58-d205-4814-a090-e4e12c305d67</td><td>15 February 2024 14:16:14 (UTC+5)</td><td>Accepted</td><td></td></tr></tbody></table>	Submission time	Submission identifier	Completion time	Status	Download	16 February 2024 14:29:33 (UTC+5)	46488d14-53aa-4f8d-a660-a5e45a540b3c	16 February 2024 14:29:43 (UTC+5)	All rejected		16 February 2024 14:28:07 (UTC+5)	682b750-b071-4a74-a090-0ce6bfc2a629	16 February 2024 14:28:17 (UTC+5)	Accepted		16 February 2024 14:26:25 (UTC+5)	0b83d99f-e342-469f-8430-14773c348273	16 February 2024 14:26:37 (UTC+5)	Accepted		15 February 2024 14:15:47 (UTC+5)	f0deaf58-d205-4814-a090-e4e12c305d67	15 February 2024 14:16:14 (UTC+5)	Accepted	
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15 February 2024 14:15:47 (UTC+5)	f0deaf58-d205-4814-a090-e4e12c305d67	15 February 2024 14:16:14 (UTC+5)	Accepted																							
Q20. In the Manual Data Entry module, how is the WWUID (Worldwide Unique Case Identification) generated?	The WWUID consists of two parts: - Constant section: A 2-letter Country ISO code followed by the HCR Short Name. - Variable section: A unique, consecutive number of at least 5 digits. When entering a report, the constant part is automatically set by the system and should not be modified. You are responsible for assigning the variable part, starting with 00001 for your first report. Each subsequent report must have a unique, incremented number to ensure proper identification. Safety report unique identifier [xx] - HCR Name Worldwide unique case identification [xx] - HCR Name 00001 00001 Constant section (not modifiable) Variable section (Serial number sequence)																									
Q21. What's the difference between the Safety Report	A WWUID is the initial identifier. The Safety Report ID may follow the same format. For manual entries, both IDs should be the																									

Unique Identifier (SRUID) and the WWUID?	same
Q22. If I'm going to report a follow-up, do I need to enter the entire case again?	No, it does not require entering the entire case again. After submitting the initial case in the manual data entry module, you should immediately download the XML file and save it to your computer directory (it is recommended to establish procedures to manage and back up these files). When you need to follow up, you must choose the "Follow up report" option from the top menu of Data Entry; here you need to open the initial case file and once this is done the system will load all the information you initially entered. You must make the modifications and additions of information that the follow-up requires, also adding in the Narrative Case field, the additional follow-up narrative. (Process described in Section 3.7. Follow up report). Remember that the acklog file should not be used in this activity as the file is not designed for tracking.
Q23. What should I do if the Submission Status section shows no end time, the status is "pending," and the acklog is not available for download?	This situation does not require immediate reporting. The system is continuously monitored, and the transmission timestamp along with the submission identifier can serve as evidence that the report was sent. Once the transmission is successfully processed, the system will automatically generate the acklog, which will then be available for download for 35 days. It is the user's responsibility to monitor the status and download the acklog promptly to complete the case documentation. When downloading the acklog, ensure it contains the following confirmation of successful transmission: <acknowledgement type Code="AA"> AA – Application Acknowledgment Accept (message successfully processed, no further action) If the acklog contains one of the following codes, further action is required: • AE – Application Acknowledgment Error (some ICSR messages need correction) • AR – Application Acknowledgment Reject (parsing error; the entire transaction must be resent)

Q24. What should I do when using the E2B upload module, and my XML case is rejected?	The acklog will indicate the reason for rejection. Follow your internal procedures to correct the errors and re-upload the XML file.
Q25. Will the latest version of MedDRA be used in eReporting for Industry?	Yes, the platform uses the most recent MedDRA version and updates it in line with MSSO releases
Q26. When transitioning from the manual data entry module to the E2B Upload module, do we need to change the identifiers?	No, the identifiers must remain the same as those initially used in the manual data entry module. Maintaining consistency ensures that the XML files generated for E2B upload are correctly recognized by the system and helps prevent issues with case reception and follow-up tracking.
Q27. My company represents multiple HCRs/CROs. How should I configure the identifiers?	If your company represents multiple HCRs or CROs, you must notify the SAHPRA of the required identifiers for each entity you represent. These include: • Long name • Short name • Sender ID • Sender organization <u>Recommended configuration:</u> If, for example, PV Company A represents HCR B, you should: • Use HCR B's identifiers (short name, sender ID, sender organization) • Format the long name as: Long name HCR B (PV Company A) This format ensures that the report is correctly attributed to HCR B while indicating that PV Company A is acting on its behalf. When logging into the system, you will be able to select which HCR/CRO you are representing. If you need to switch to another company, you can do so by selecting the Switch organisation option available in the upper right corner of the screen. 

Q28. In the event of an error in the platform and/or unavailability of the system, is there any other option for reporting cases?	eReporting for Industry is continuously monitored and updated by the UMC to ensure its correct operation. When the UMC performs updates, it takes no more than a few hours to complete, so access may be intermittent for some users. In this case, you must wait at least 3 hours, then try to access the system again. If you cannot access Industry eReporting for more than 24 hours and it is due to a cause unrelated to the UMC (you can document, it with a screenshot if your internal procedure requests it) and immediately report the error to industryreporting@sahpra.org.za and constantly monitor until service is restored. If you have a problem accessing the platform, please try the following: • Access from the link found in this manual and not through the one saved in your computer's cache or history. • Delete the cookies of the browser used. • Access the platform through another browser. • Make sure that the correct username and password are entered. • If you have forgotten your password, you must generate another one so that you can access the module.
Q29. How can I report issues not covered in this guide?	Please report any additional issues to the SAHPRA via email at industryreporting@sahpra.org.za
Q30. What happens if a case upload is interrupted?	You must complete, submit, or download the report in a single session. Contact SAHPRA to confirm whether the case is reflected in VigiFlow.
Q31. What happens if the system times out after data entry?	The system does not support saving drafts. You must complete, submit, or download the report in a single session. Any data will be lost upon logout or system timeout. Downloading the report is only possible if it meets the minimum submission criteria outlined in the previous question.
Q32. What happens when a case appears submitted but no acknowledgement is generated?	This situation is unexpected and must be reported to industryreporting@sahpra.org.za. The system is continuously monitored, and the transmission timestamp along with the submission identifier can serve as evidence that the report was sent. Once the transmission is successfully processed, the system will

	automatically generate the acklog, which will then be available for download for 35 days. It is the user's responsibility to monitor the status and download the acklog promptly to complete the case documentation.
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5. REFERENCES

The following related documents are referenced:

- Post-marketing reporting of ADR to Human Medicines (SAHPGL-CEM-PV-04)
- ICH guidelines: <https://ich.org/page/e2br3-individual-case-safety-report-icsr-specification-and-related-files>

6. VALIDITY

This guideline is valid for a period of five (5) years from the effective date of revision. It will be reviewed within this timeframe or as and when required.

7. APPENDICES

7.1 APPENDIX 1: Terms and Conditions

Terms and conditions for the eReporting service for the pharmaceutical industry

The eReporting service for the pharmaceutical industry (“eReporting Service”) provides secure means for electronic transmission of suspected reactions to medicines, e.g. the transmission of individual case safety reports (“ICSRs”) from a market authorization holder, or other obligated reporters to the National Health Authority’s national database named Vigiflow.

A subset of WHODrug Global, which is a drug dictionary to which UMC holds all intellectual property rights, will be available in the data entry interface of the eReporting Service and such subset of WHODrug Global may only be used for the purpose of transmitting suspected reactions to medicines to the National Health Authority through the eReporting Service.

The eReporting Service is developed and hosted by Uppsala Monitoring Centre (“UMC”).

General terms and conditions

- You, as a user with login credentials to eReporting Service, certify that you represent a company with a valid and ongoing WHODrug License Agreement with UMC
- You understand that in the event of a prolonged unavailability of the eReporting Service you must be aware of any alternative process described by the national health authority in order to meet the regulatory reporting time frames.
- You understand that UMC is not in any case liable for unmet reporting obligations due to incomplete transmissions, service interruptions or of any other reasons emanating from providing the services.
- You as a user with login credentials to eReporting Service understand that your account is personal and that you may not under any circumstance share your login credentials with another person.
- You as a user with login credentials to eReporting Service, will Safeguard your password to eReporting Service.
- If you become aware of any unauthorized use of your account, we advise you to immediately change your password and report the suspicion to the company that you represent.
- You agree that UMC may, for statistical and product enhancement purposes, save information about your use of eReporting Service.
- You agree that UMC may at any time collect and receive information from your activities within the eReporting Service to ensure that you adhere to these terms and conditions.
- You understand that you should contact the national health authority, who is responsible for the management and control of your user account, if you have any questions regarding the user account.

Non-acceptable use

You agree not to misuse the eReporting Service or help anyone else to do so. For example, you must not try to do any of the following in connection with the eReporting Service:

- Probe, scan or test the vulnerability of any system or network.
- Breach or otherwise circumvent any security or authentication measures.
- Use eReporting Service in any way that is unlawful, illegal, fraudulent or harmful, or in connection with any unlawful, illegal, fraudulent or harmful purpose or activity.

- Copy, store, host, transmit, send, use, publish or distribute any material which consists of (or is linked to) any spyware, computer virus, Trojan horse, worm, keystroke logger, rootkit or other malicious computer software.
- Share materials that are unlawfully pornographic or indecent, or that contain extreme acts of violence.
- You understand that a breach of these terms and conditions might lead to suspension of your user account.

APPROVED

7.2 APPENDIX 2: ICH E2B ACKLOG

ICH E2B acknowledgement message (acklog) is available for download for each ICSR/batch submission in 'Submission status'. The acklog is your receipt for the submission and contains information regarding the outcome of the submission, e.g., if the submission was successful or if there was any failure to meet the reporting requirements.

E2B(R2)

OK

01=All reports loaded into database

`<transmissionacknowledgmentcode>01</transmissionacknowledgmentcode>`

01=Report loaded successfully

`<reportacknowledgmentcode>01</reportacknowledgmentcode>`

Error

02=Not accepted

`<transmissionacknowledgmentcode>02</transmissionacknowledgmentcode>`

`<parsingerrormessage>Could not understand the import format!</parsingerrormessage>`

03=SGML parsing error

`<transmissionacknowledgmentcode>03</transmissionacknowledgmentcode>`

`<parsingerrormessage>Message sender and/or receiver identifier doesn't match expected values</parsingerrormessage>`

E2B(R3)

OK

AA=Accept - successfully processed

Transmission Acknowledgement Code;

`<acknowledgement typeCode="AA">`

CA=Commit Accept

Acknowledgement Code for an ICSR Message;

`<acknowledgement typeCode="CA">`

Error

CR=Commit Reject (not loaded)

`<acknowledgement typeCode="CR">` or `<acknowledgementDetail>`

`<acknowledgementDetail> <text>Invalid MedDRA code found: 0</text>`

`<text>Existing ICSR is nullified, followup not allowed.</text>`

AE=Parsial

`<acknowledgement typeCode="AE">`

`<acknowledgementDetail>`

`<text>Could not persist all information</text>`

AR=Reject

<acknowledgement typeCode="AR">

<acknowledgementDetail>

<text>Could not understand the import data: The 'extension' attribute is invalid - The value " is invalid according to its datatype 'urn:hl7-org:v3:st' - The actual length is less than the MinLength value., Line: 17 Position: 53. The 'extension' attribute is invalid - The value " is invalid according to its datatype 'urn:hl7-org:v3:st' - The actual length is less than the MinLength value., Line: 426 Position: 51. </text>

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7.3 PPENDIX 2. ADDENDUM

For submission of AEs through the E2B XML files, please complete the table below in your letterhead and submit to SAHPRA PV Unit (industryereporting@sahpra.org.za).

Table 1: Organisation and user details for submission of AEs through E2B XML files

Country:		South Africa
Country ISO Code:		ZA
Pharmaceutical company name		
Short name (populates WWUID*):		
Long name (legal name):		
Sender organisation (in E2B XML)		
Sender identifier (in E2B XML)		
Receiver identifier (in E2B XML):		SAHPRA
User 1	Given name:	-
	Family name:	
	Email:	
User 2	Given name:	
	Family name:	
	Email:	-
User 3	Given name:	
	Family name:	
	Email:	-

* WWUID - Worldwide unique case identification

For submission of AEs through manual data entry, please complete the table below in your letterhead and submit to SAHPRA PV Unit (industryreporting@sahpra.org.za).

Table 2: Organisation and user details for submission of AEs through manual data entry

Country:		South Africa
Country ISO Code:		ZA
Pharmaceutical company name		
Short name (populates WWUID*):		
Long name (legal name):		
User 1	Given name:	-
	Family name:	
	Email:	
User 2	Given name:	
	Family name:	
	Email:	-
User 3	Given name:	
	Family name:	
	Email:	-

* WWUID - Worldwide unique case identification